EMBODIED MUSIC PEDAGOGY
Workshop

MELISSA BREMMER

LUC NIJS

BASIC MECHANISMS OF MUSICAL SENSE-MAKING

ENTRAINMENT

Concept of entrainment: 'the coordination of temporally structured events through interaction' (Clayton et al, 2004)

i.e. through interaction with the group, you are pulled towards a certain beat.

You can feel how you're pulled towards a certain beat or to others.
Develop a sense of a time framework.

ALIGNMENT

As soon as the music begins, people start physically aligning their movements to certain aspects of the music. Two common types of alignment (Leman, 2016):

1. **Phase alignment:**
   - helps to *physically* express one's understanding of the global timing framework of the music
   - *discrete* movements help children understand the global timing framework of the music (tempo, pulse) because the body is providing them with kinesthetic feedback on their match between the perceived music and the overt movement

2. **Inter-phase alignment:**
   - helps children to *physically* express one's understanding of the unfolding of the music (atmosphere of music, musical dynamics, contour of melodies, tension and release)

continuous expressive movements help child understand music as a flow of organized sounds, of which salient and expressive moments can be highlighted through movement

Physical manifestation of entrainment

PREDICTION

Being pulled towards the beat (entrainment) is not enough. To be able to keep the beat it is necessary to predict when the next beat is coming.

Prediction is related to the bodily experience: movements provide a physical sensation of recurring patterns, helping to anticipate what comes next.

Prediction is also related to finding a personal timing framework.
Physically engaging with different types of music helps developing this basic mechanism, by promoting flexibility and adaptivity

Such bodily experiences are influenced by culturally defined music repertoire.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Form pairs
2. Choose one of the basic mechanisms
3. Design one or more (instrumental) music activities for your student(s), based on the chosen basic mechanism
4. Describe the activity, using the following online document:
   go to: https://bit.ly/isme_EMP or scan the code:

5. Present your activity to the group